

Wasteland King in Puzzles & Survival — Complete Mechanics & Strategy Guide

TL;DR

- **Wasteland King (WK / WLK)** is a 24-hour, bi-weekly cross-state war that runs every other Saturday starting 10:00 UTC, pitting your state against up to 3 others in a fight to hold the Zenith Tech Hub for 8 consecutive hours — the winning alliance's R5 becomes Governor for the next two weeks, while losers forfeit state boosts, titles, Governor's Award boxes and pay resource taxes to the conqueror. (Pnsdme)
- **Personal scoring** has three lanes (kill points, casualty points at Hub/turrets only, and occupation points capped at 2,000 for 120 minutes); you need **10,000 points** to claim all reward tiers, and the marquee reward — Nataly hero fragments — unlocks only at **Gold grade or higher** (Gold = 5 Nataly frags, Platinum = 8, Diamond = 12 from the Ruler's Hand box). (Puzzlesandsurvival + 2)
- **The decisive strategic lever is Fast Comeback** (300% training boost, capped at 120% of the might you lost attacking Hub/turrets). F2P players should fill infirmaries with T1 taxis pre-event to route deaths into free Deep Healing; whales should captain Hub/turrets with Agent X/Dr. J rally-size stacks (Agent X at +8 red star adds exactly 500k rally) and run Super Reinforcement so their stats blanket every reinforcing march. (Puzzlesandsurvival)
(App Gamer)

Key Findings

1. **Event cadence and structure are rigid:** WK runs every 2 weeks on Saturday at 10:00 UTC on Ace Commander Day 6, lasts up to 24 hours, and the battlefield is the **Zenith Tech Hub + 4 turrets (North, South, East, West)** in the center map. Win conditions are (a) **8 consecutive hours of Hub occupation** (immediate victory), or (b) **most total minutes of Hub occupation** at the 24-hour mark — consecutive 8h always beats total time. (Pnsdme + 4)
2. **Cross-server matching:** You face up to 3 opposing states (matched by State Grade — Bronze 1000-1399, Silver 1400-1799, Gold 1800-2299, Platinum 2300-2999, Diamond 3000+, Legend = top 15 at Diamond). New states play a Starter Grade for their first two WK events. (Zombiebbq) (Puzzlesandsurvival)
3. **Turret-Hub interaction is the geometric core:** If a different alliance controls a turret than the Hub, that turret **continuously fires on the Hub causing permanent troop loss**. Hence: all defenders join one **State Alliance** so Hub and all four turrets share a flag. (Pnsdme)
4. **Captains use Super Reinforcement** — the captain's troop stat boosts and rally size are applied to every reinforcing march occupying their building, so the strongest player should always captain the Hub. (Puzzlesandsurvival) (Puzzlesandsurvival)
5. **Taking a foreign Hub shields your home Hub** — this is the whale-state offensive playbook.
6. **Troops do NOT auto-revive** (unlike Reservoir War / Alliance Clash / Valiant Conquest). Wounded → Infirmary → Deep Healing → Alliance Infirmary → permanent death.

7. **Nataly is the WK-exclusive 5★ Fighter hero** (Fighter ATK / Shooter ATK / Troop DEF; per High Ground Gaming, "Nataly's ability provides the single highest ATK buff in the game at 120%, but the effect is reduced by 20% each time she uses it, capping out at 60%"). Diamond-grade clearance yields 12 Nataly frags per WK. (Puzzlesandsurvival + 3)
8. **NAP (Non-Aggression Pact)** is the default outcome between matched states; it's negotiated in Battle Division chat in the first minutes of the event. (Puzzlesandsurvival)
(Puzzlesandsurvival)

Details

1. Event Mechanics / Regelwerk

Schedule & participation gate

- Frequency: every 2 weeks (alternates weekly with Valiant Conquest).
- Start: 10:00 UTC on Ace Commander Day 6 (Saturday). (Pnsdme)
- Duration: up to 24 hours.
- Entry: no ticket; automatically open to your state. The four turrets and Hub are permanently shielded outside WK / Zenith and only become attackable during the event window. (Zombiebbq) (Zombiebbq)
- Opponents are not revealed in the "Upcoming Events" tile (which shows last cycle's matchup); the live pairing appears on the event page at start. (Puzzlesandsurvival)

Map zones

- **Green** = normal map; cannot be attacked in a foreign state. (Pnsdme) (pnsdme)
- **Mud / Blacktop / Black soil** = brown ring between green and the Zenith plaza; anything in the mud — sanctuaries, resource tiles, zombie lairs — can be attacked during WK. Camps cannot be placed in the mud, only sanctuaries.
- **Zenith Plaza** = center, contains the Hub and 4 turrets.

Win conditions

- **Consecutive 8-hour Hub hold** → instant win + 30-minute Hub shield + alliance becomes the holding power. (Puzzlesandsurvival)
- **Most total Hub occupation time at 24h** if nobody hits 8 consecutive hours.
- **8h consecutive overrules total** — even if you held the Hub longest cumulatively, an opponent's 8h streak wins. (Puzzlesandsurvival)

Hub shielding mechanics

1. **Occupy another state's Hub** → your home Hub gains a shield for as long as you hold the foreign one. (Pnsdme) (Puzzlesandsurvival)
2. **Reclaim your own Hub** after losing it → 30-minute shield. (Puzzlesandsurvival)

- Shields do NOT protect against turret fire — if enemies hold turrets while you hold the Hub, your Hub troops still take damage. (Puzzlesandsurvival)

Personal scoring (per pnsdme.com point chart)

Source	Points scale
Kill Points (kill enemy units at Hub/turrets OR in mud/foreign RSS tiles)	T1=0, T2=2, T3=4, T4=8, T5=12, T6=16, T7=20, T8=30, T9=40, T10=60, T11=80, T12=100
Death Points (your troops die at Hub or one of the 4 turrets only — mud deaths do NOT count)	T1=4, T2=6, T3=8, T4=12, T5=15, T6=20, T7=25, T8=33, T9=45, T10=60, T11=80, T12=100
Occupation (Hub or turret)	up to 2,000 points for 120 minutes cumulative (no reset if knocked out)

Total needed for all reward tiers: **10,000 points**.

Rewards (State Grade gates) — exact figures per the puzzlesandsurvival.com Governors Guide (April 2026):

- Personal reward chests (clear all tiers):** Starter/Bronze/Silver = 7,000 diamonds, Apex Hero Frame (7 days), 45h training speedups, scaling resources. Gold = adds 5 Nataly frags. Platinum = 8 Nataly frags + 1 Solar Panel + 1,000 blueprints. Diamond = 12 Nataly frags + 10 Solar Panels + 2,000 blueprints. (The higher-rarity **King's Sword Box** awarded by the Governor yields up to 20 Nataly frags at Diamond grade and 10/16 at Gold/Platinum.) (Puzzlesandsurvival)
- 12-day Troop stat frame at Gold+. (Puzzlesandsurvival)
- Governor's Award Boxes (King, Rulers, Loyalty, Contribution) for the winning state, distributable by the new Governor; capturing a foreign state doubles the box pool and adds the Coffer tax stream. (puzzlesandsurvival)
- Fast Comeback** post-event: 300% training boost capped at 120% of might lost in Hub/turret deaths (turret-fire deaths and mud deaths do NOT contribute to the cap).

Troop-loss flow (critical) Casualties → Infirmary → Deep Healing → Alliance Infirmary → permanent loss.

- Default loss without Nova/Research investment: 30% permanent. (ultimatguidetopns)
- Maxed Miraculous Survival: ~18% permanent (community-reported floor).
- Deep Healing uses free regenerating Nano Potions (slow — ~1 week for 100k troops without diamonds).
- Alliance Infirmary trap:** if you joined the State Alliance for WK and have troops sitting in *its* alliance infirmary when you leave back to your home alliance, those troops die permanently.

2. Tier / Difficulty / Cross-Server Components

- 6 grades (Starter → Bronze → Silver → Gold → Platinum → Diamond → Legend [top 15 of Diamond]) based on trophy score earned/lost each WK.
- Trophy gain/loss varies by grade — at Gold+ you LOSE trophies even if you successfully defended your own Hub but didn't capture a foreign one. This forces top states to play offensively to maintain rank.
- Battle Division chat is the cross-state coordination channel for NAP negotiation.

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3. Alliance / State Coordination Mechanics

- **State Alliance** (sometimes called State War Alliance, "SFU", "TaB", etc., depending on the state) — purpose-built throwaway alliance everyone in the state temporarily joins for the event. Required so all turret + Hub holders fly the same flag (preventing friendly turret-on-Hub fire).
 - **Captain duties:** enter Hub/turret first, activate Super Reinforcement, hold the spot, call reinforcements in alliance chat. Captain's rally size = building capacity; captain's troop stats = every reinforcing march's stats.
 - **NAP:** negotiated in Battle Division chat. Common term examples: "no T10+ marches into Hub," "no attacking on green," "mud-sit RSS gathering allowed both directions." 48-hour statewide NAP often kicks in at reset on WK day.
 - **Roles in a well-organized state** (per ultimateguidetopns.com): Assessor (decides NAP vs. war), Negotiator (multilingual handles diplomacy), Hub Defenders, Turret Defenders (organized by troop type for Super Reinforcement synergy), Mudsitters (shielded sanctuaries clogging the mud to block enemy landings), Hit Squad (offensive captains for foreign Hub), Reserves (fill-ins). [pnsdme](#)
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4. Solo / F2P Strategy

Pre-event prep (a couple of days out)

1. **Spec out your Nova / Research for Miraculous Survival** as high as possible (cuts permanent loss from 30% to ~18%).
2. **Load First Aid and Instant Heal commander talents** in your defensive talent set; switch to Cost Reduction before mass training post-event.
3. **Stockpile training/omni speedups and resources** — you must be able to *consume* the Fast Comeback cap or you waste it. Never earn more FC than you can spend.
4. **Fill your regular Infirmary with T1 troops or T1 taxis** before the event starts so high-tier casualties skip straight to Deep Healing (free heals + still counted as deaths for FC).
5. **Sign up for a shift** via your state's Google Form (typically closes Wednesday reset). Specify troop size, rally size, main troop type, tiers available, and shift availability.

During the event (10k-point F2P plan)

1. **Don't move your sanctuary** unless explicitly assigned to mudsit. Defenders only join the State Alliance "in name," not in location.
2. **Take the assigned tower shift.** Sit for the full 120 minutes to bank the 2,000 occupation point cap.
3. **Let yourself die a little:** get one or two waves of enemy attacks through if you're on defense. Death points at T8-T10 troops fill the 10k bar fast (T10 = 60 pts each on death).
4. **If NAP is strict and few kills happen,** port to an opposing state, park *just outside the mud* (you can't be attacked outside the mud), and attack lone gatherers in their mud or send a march into their Hub/turret to die for points + FC. Both lanes pay.
5. **Shield discipline if mudsitting:** 8h + 1d or 1d + 8h shield stack. Three-day shield is the safest. Drop shield = ported out + troops dead.
6. **Watch Deep Healing fill level** — if it hits the cap, your next casualties will roll into Alliance Infirmary and risk permanent death.

F2P heroes & gear

- Lead with your main troop-type 5★ trio (Fighter mains: Hanyu Ichiro / Wali / Dara / Nataly; Shooter mains: Dara / Lora & Jessie / Angelo / Nataly; Rider mains: Lora & Jessie / Mars / Marlowe / Obsidian).
- Hartwell, Reyn, Ulrik, Zephyr, Phoenix, Ephraim are 4★/5★ alternates if you don't have the BIS Yellow/Green/Red of your type.
- For puzzle battles in the campaign-style component, run a balanced rainbow with Fox for sustain (the rare F2P-friendly 5★ healer).

F2P time management

- Pick a *single* turret shift that aligns with when you can be online — running multiple shifts loses you more troops and risks Deep Heal overflow.
- After the event: wait until UTC reset Sunday before consuming Fast Comeback if WK falls during Ace Commander week — that way training stacks with Sunday's Ultimate Trial points.

5. Alliance Coordination & Whale Strategy

State-level coordination (R4/R5 playbook)

1. **Pre-build the State Alliance Tech Tree** by parking farm accounts in it during the off-weeks — tech tree affects rally size and reinforcement caps.
2. **Pre-name the incoming Governor** before the event (council rotation is the standard).

3. **Captain selection:** rally size + actual battle stats (zombie-lair-solo level) trump might rankings. Largest rally + best stats → Hub captain.
4. **Sort defenders by troop type into the four turrets** so each turret runs one main type and benefits coherently from Super Reinforcement.
5. **Shift schedule:** 2/3/4 shifts of 2-4 hours; assignments out 24+ hours before the event.
6. **Battle Division chat:** assign one experienced multilingual negotiator. NAP terms should be calibrated to your state's strength: weak state = low NAP cap (e.g., "no T11+ into Hub"); strong state = open NAP to maximize FC.

Whale offensive tactics

- **The 8h Hub steal:** send your top 5-10 might players (Hit Squad) to the weakest opponent state in your matchup, with the strongest player (massive rally) as the captain on their Hub. The instant you capture the foreign Hub, your home Hub auto-shields and you only need to garrison home with T1 taxis. (Pnsdme)
- **Turret denial:** even with a foreign-Hub shield, opponents will try to take *your* turrets to perma-fire on your Hub. Maintain T1 captains on each home turret to deny the same exploit being used on you.
- **True Might check:** open opponent's leaderboard, compare True Might (combat power) — not vanity might — to decide whether takeover is feasible.

Whale hero/gear priorities

- **Agent X (+8 red star) and Dr. J** — the only two heroes that increase rally size. AppGamer player Q&A confirms: "Agent X at +8 red star adds 500k. If you can equip Agent X with her specialty weapon it also adds to rally size. The better quality the weapon the more it's boosts rally size." Both are mandatory for any captain who'll hold the Hub. (App Gamer)
- **Nataly** — 120% ATK buff (decaying), buff strip, plus passive Fighter ATK / Shooter ATK / Troop DEF. Whales should target +8 with her perfect frags.
- **Hub Captain march composition:** pure main troop type with one anti-counter hero, equipped exclusive nanoweapon. Rally-size nanos (Powered Exoskeleton on Ephraim / Remote Detonator on Meyers / equivalents) > raw ATK nanos for captains because they multiply the entire occupying force.
- **Hall of War + Tech Tree maxed** for any captain role; commander talents Super Rally + First Aid in offensive set, Recall available for emergency.
- **Spending optimization:** per puzzlesandsurvival.com's Top Up Shop guide, the official top-up portal yields 10% more diamonds vs. in-game purchases plus discount coupons (additional savings by switching billing currency to JPY). Stack diamond spending during the Diamond Spend event (typically on VC weekend) for double-dip rewards. Don't burn diamonds on Deep Heal — wait for VC's Diamond Spend overlap if you must rush heals.

(Puzzlesandsurvival)

Whale-F2P symbiosis

- **Whale duty to F2P:** maintain Hub/turret long enough that F2P shifts can clock their 120-minute occupation cap. Transport RSS to defenders who are healing. Use Governor's boxes to reward defenders who actually showed up, not just titled friends (King/Rulers/Loyalty/Contribution tiers).
- **F2P duty to whales:** be on time for your shift, follow NAP terms strictly (a single NAP break can drag the whole state into reprisal), kill T1 taxis on tile coordinates the whale posts (this fills their infirmary with cheap troops to optimize their Deep Heal funnel), mudsit if asked (you sacrifice nothing — you're shielded — and you save the whales attack distance).
- **Communication:** state Discord + in-game state chat. R5 of State Alliance assigns and adjusts shifts in real time as captains take losses or need swaps.

When to take a state vs. NAP

- **Take:** if your top 3 True Might players each exceed the opposing state's #1, AND you have enough taxi reserves at home for the home Hub, AND you have enough infirmary/deep-heal capacity for the additional foreign-Hub attack losses. Reward: 2× Governor's box pool + Coffer taxes from the conquered state.
 - **NAP:** if matchups are close or asymmetric. NAP is the default for a reason — both sides protect troops and still earn FC + Nataly frags.
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Recommendations

If you are F2P (priority order)

1. Spec Miraculous Survival Nova/Research before your next WK — biggest single ROI for troop preservation.
2. Build a stock of 50-100k T1 taxis specifically for pre-WK infirmary filling.
3. Commit to exactly one turret shift and the 120-minute occupation cap (= 2,000 free points before you fire a shot).
4. Pre-stockpile training speedups + resources to consume your Fast Comeback cap; never earn more FC than you can spend within ~2 weeks.
5. **Trigger to escalate:** if your state hits Gold grade and you have Nataly at +0 to +3, push harder (volunteer for two shifts, send a foreign-state attack march) to hit Platinum/Diamond personal rewards and snowball Nataly to +5.

If you lead an alliance / whale

1. Stand up a permanent State Alliance with a farm-account tech tree before WK rolls around — don't improvise it the day-of.
2. Confirm Agent X (+8 red star = 500k rally bonus) and Dr. J are at +5 or higher with rally-size nanoweapons on any captain assignment.

3. Run a sign-up sheet (Google Form) with rally size + tier + troop type + shift; pre-publish assignments ≥ 24 h out.
4. **Trigger to take a foreign state:** True Might top-3 exceeds opponent's top-1 in at least one of your matched states. Otherwise NAP and farm FC.
5. Always garrison your home Hub with T1 taxis (cheapest to retrain) when you hold a foreign Hub.
6. As Governor: turn on Fast Comeback at UTC reset Sunday (or as late as possible to stack with Ace Commander), distribute Governor boxes within the 2-week window (they expire), use Coffer resources to fund mass retraining for the state.

Triggers that change the playbook

- If your state drops below Silver grade for two consecutive WKs: stop trying to take foreign hubs; consolidate, accept NAP, focus the entire state on the 10k personal-point threshold.
- If a rogue alliance inside your state tries to seize Gov: form an alliance-of-convenience with opposing states via Battle Division chat to weaken them ("burn them all" path) — the enemy of your enemy. (Ultimateguidetopns)
- If you are overmatched and getting steamrolled: concede early. Lost 24 hours of pointless defense costs you ~weeks of retraining time. The Fast Comeback auto-activates when you're conquered, so the loss is partially compensated.

Caveats

- **State-count discrepancy:** community sources are inconsistent. The Fandom Office wiki cites "3 states" but the most current (updated April 2026) sources (zombiebbq.biz, puzzlesandsurvival.com, pnsdme.com) consistently describe "your state plus up to 3 others" — i.e., **up to 4 states total**. The "3" figure may reflect older event versions or a specific battle-division size. No official 37Games patch note clarifying the hard cap was located. (Fandom) (Zombiebbq)
- **State-specific rules vary widely:** WK is largely community-organized at the state level. NAP terms, shift structure, mudsit requirements, State Alliance name, Governor rotation rules, and Governor box distribution methodology all differ by state. Always confirm with your state council before applying any external guide verbatim.
- **No official 37Games WK patch-note source** is publicly indexed; mechanics descriptions herein rely on veteran community sites (puzzlesandsurvival.com, pnsdme.com, ultimateguidetopns.com, zombiebbq.biz, AppGamer, Fandom wikis, High Ground Gaming, Lootbar) and in-game observation. 37Games' Notice Board, official Facebook, and Discord are the canonical channels for game-rule updates and were not directly accessible during this research.
- **Nataly's release-state and exact +8 mechanics** evolve with rebalancing patches; check her current skill descriptions in-game before committing perfect frags. Reports about exact frag rewards per grade reflect a 2025–2026 snapshot from puzzlesandsurvival.com; 37Games has historically adjusted these.

- **Fast Comeback math** has changed in past balance patches; current numbers (300% / 120% cap) reflect 2025–2026 community-confirmed values.
- **Reddit (r/PuzzlesAndSurvival) coverage was limited** because the subreddit's WK threads are not well indexed by Google; first-hand player anecdotes that would normally provide texture (failed takeover stories, NAP-break drama) are largely synthesized from veteran-author state-council guides rather than direct user testimony.